

## MODERN FRIGATES AND DESTROYERS

While the aircraft carrier and the nuclear-powered submarine are the capital ships of today's major naval forces, smaller escort vessels remain as necessary as ever. The distinction between destroyers and frigates has become more indefinite during the post-war era, with the (larger) destroyer and the (smaller) frigate dispensing with some of their guns in favour of an array of guided missiles as their main armament. Escort vessels have usually been classified into anti-aircraft or anti-submarine vessels, but most are capable of performing a variety of tasks.

### ► HMS DIAMOND

**Commissioned** 1952   **Origin** UK  
**Displacement** 3,580 tons  
**Length** 119m (390ft)  
**Top speed** 30 knots

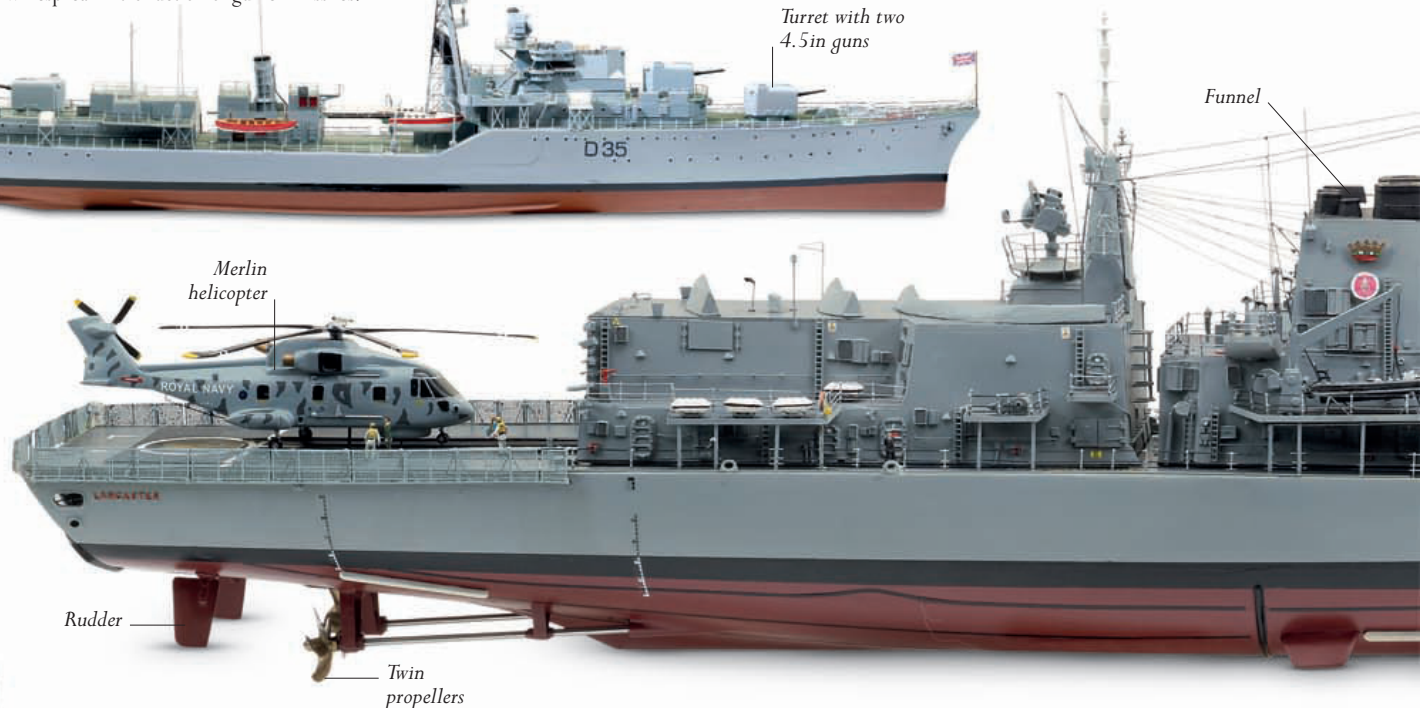
As a *Daring*-class destroyer, *Diamond* was the last such vessel in the British Royal Navy to be fitted with guns as its main armament before the widespread introduction of guided missiles.



### ► HMS LANCASTER

**Commissioned** 1992   **Origin** UK  
**Displacement** 4,200 tons  
**Length** 133m (436ft)  
**Top speed** 32 knots

A Type-23 frigate, *Lancaster* is a versatile multirole vessel, armed with Sea Wolf anti-aircraft missiles, Harpoon anti-ship missiles, and Stingray anti-submarine torpedoes.



### ▼ HMS SHEFFIELD

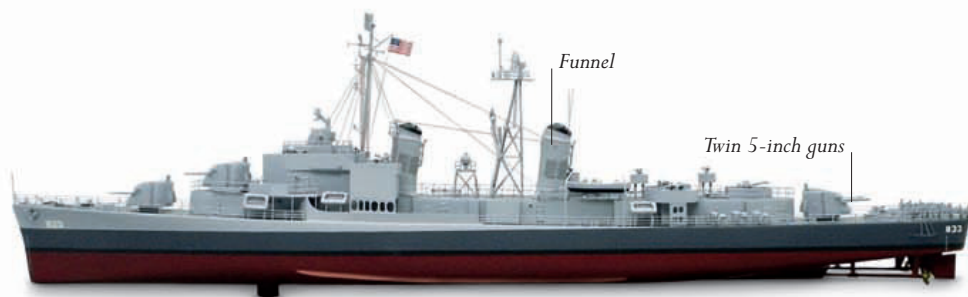
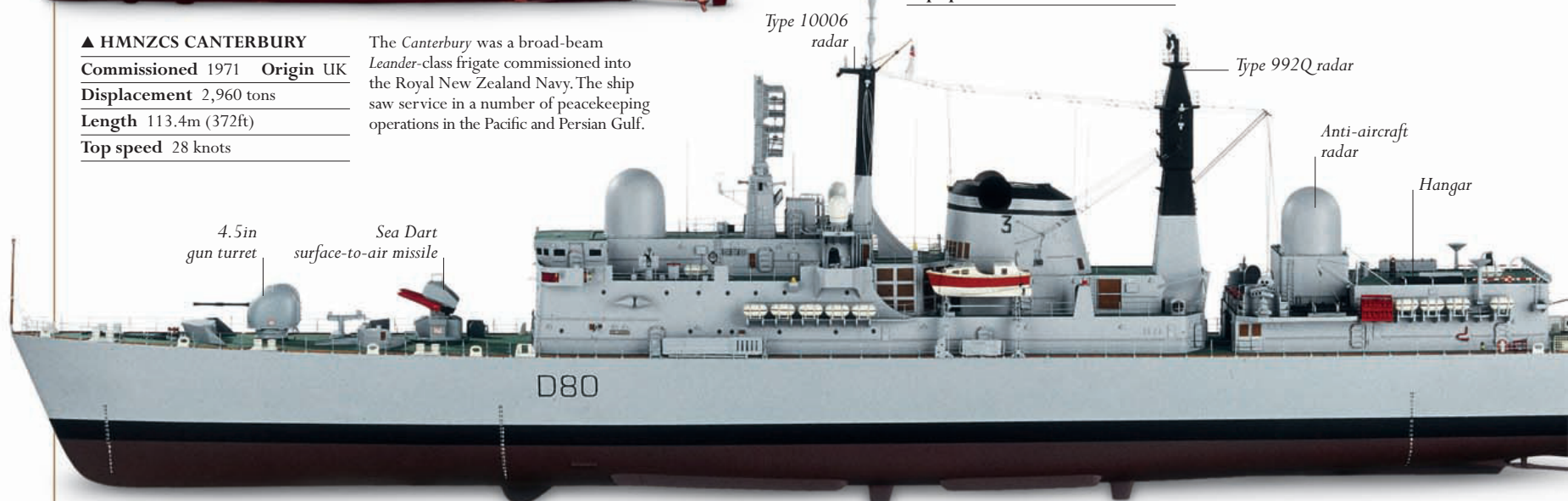
**Commissioned** 1975   **Origin** UK  
**Displacement** 4,350 tons  
**Length** 125m (410ft)  
**Top speed** 30 knots

A Type-42 Guided Missile Destroyer, *Sheffield* took part in the Falklands campaign of 1982. While on patrol off the Falkland Islands, *Sheffield* was sunk by an Exocet missile fired by an Argentinian naval aircraft.

### ▲ HMNZCS CANTERBURY

**Commissioned** 1971   **Origin** UK  
**Displacement** 2,960 tons  
**Length** 113.4m (372ft)  
**Top speed** 28 knots

The *Canterbury* was a broad-beam *Leander*-class frigate commissioned into the Royal New Zealand Navy. The ship saw service in a number of peacekeeping operations in the Pacific and Persian Gulf.



### ▲ USS HERBERT J THOMAS

**Commissioned** 1945   **Origin** US  
**Displacement** 3,460 tons  
**Length** 119m (390ft)  
**Top speed** 36.8 knots

One of 98 *Gearing*-class anti-aircraft destroyers, the *Herbert J Thomas* was designed for long-range patrols in the Pacific, and was armed with six 5-inch guns in three turrets. It took part in both the Korean and Vietnam Wars.